

Chunks loaded by ender pearls permanently unload upon player death even when enderPearlsVanishOnDeath is set to false

MC-299770 chunk loading

Status	Resolved / Fixed
Affected	1.21.7, 1.21.8 Release Candidate 1, 1.21.8, 25w31a
Fixed in	25w32a
Reported	2025-07-15

STEPS TO REPRODUCE

1. Open the attached example world, configured with `enderPearlsVanishOnDeath` set to false` and spectatorsGenerateChunks` set to false`.`
2. Click the button that switches you to spectator mode and teleports you to the ender pearl.
3. Observe that the chunk containing the ender pearl is loaded.
4. Run `/execute in minecraft:overworld run tp @s -6.49 63.00 10009.60 359.33 39.47`.`
5. Exit spectator mode.
6. Run `/kill`.`
7. Wait more than 2 seconds after dying.
8. Click the respawn button.
9. Click the button that switches you to spectator mode and teleports you to the ender pearl.
10. Observe that the ender pearl has reappeared, but is no longer loading the chunk it is in.

OBSERVED BEHAVIOUR

Actual behavior

When the player dies, the associated ender pearl temporarily vanishes, even though `enderPearlsVanishOnDeath` is set to false`. During this period, the pearl stops keeping its current chunk loaded.`

If the player remains on the death screen for more than approximately two seconds, the pearl's chunk unloads. After the player respawns, the pearl reappears, but it does not resume loading the chunk it occupies. As a result, the pearl remains in a state where it does not load chunks while its owner is online.

The chunk only begins loading again after the player manually travels to it. If the player respawns within approximately two seconds of dying - before the chunk unloads - the pearl continues loading its chunk as expected.

EXPECTED BEHAVIOUR

With `enderPearlsVanishOnDeath` set to false`, an ender pearl should continue loading the chunk it occupies while its associated player is dead, even if the player waits before respawning. After the player respawns, the pearl should reappear and continue loading its surrounding chunks normally, without requiring the player to manually visit the area or rapidly click the respawn button.`

ENVIRONMENT

Minecraft Java Edition Versions: 1.21.7, 1.21.8 Release Candidate 1, 1.21.8, 25w31a (includes snapshots)

ORIGINAL DESCRIPTION

This bug is related to <https://report.bugs.mojang.com/browse/MC-289348>, as it gets the ender pearl in a bugged state where they no longer load chunks at all even when the player associated with it is online. (the pearl gets deloaded).

What happens is the pearl is temporarily not loading chunks when the player is dead. If you don't rapidly respawn (click the respawn button within 2 seconds after death) the chunk the pearl is within will deload. And not reload when you respawn (which would be expected, as pearls should load chunks.). The only way to get the pearl to load these chunks again is to manually load them by walking to the chunk.

When `enderPearlsVanishOnDeath` is set to `false`, pearls still vanish on death. They just reappear when you respawn. A simple fix to this bug would be to make sure pearls continue to load the chunk they are in when they are in this temporary vanished state.

I have attached a simple world that allows you to see this bug in action. I made sure to set `spectatorsGenerateChunks` to `false` so you can see when your ender pearl is loading chunks.

Repro steps when in example world:

- Click the button that sets you to spectator mode and teleports you to your ender pearl location. Observe how the chunk your pearl is in is loaded.
- Teleport back to your spawn location `/execute in minecraft:overworld run tp @s -6.49 63.00 10009.60 359.33 39.47`
- Exit spectator mode.
- Run the `/kill` command, make sure to wait for more than two seconds before clicking respawn. (chunks pearl is in will deload)
- Click the button. You will see your pearl is not loading any chunks even though you have respawned.

To see how it should work, kill your player in step 4, but rapidly click the respawn button so you respawn in under two seconds. (preventing the chunks from deloading) You will see your pearl is still loading chunks.

MANUAL RESULT

Version used	
Reproduced?	YES / NO / PARTIAL
Crash file	
Notes	
Tested by / date	

Live issue: <https://bugs.mojang.com/browse/MC/issues/MC-299770>